

30 Minutes Expert

What's in the password?

In the world that is the Internet, since a time when everything was free, people have been hoarding online accounts offering free access to everything imaginable. It's free, how could you not sign up? So now you've signed up for free e-mail, access to forums, online shopping accounts, and all by way of that combination of characters that we call a password. The problem now is to remember all those passwords. A popular solution is to have one common password for all your online accounts; a safer bet is to recruit a simple program that will remember all your passwords for you, and even fill them in when required. AI RoboForm (www.roboform.com) is one such tool which integrates brilliantly with Internet Explorer and compatible browsers such as MyIE2 and Slim Browser. It works with other browsers too but does not offer as much functionality.

Begin the setup, and follow the on-screen instructions. After selecting the language, you are presented with three choices for setting up your identity. The first option that allows you to enter all your personal data from scratch is the ideal choice. The second and third options are for previous users of Gator and AI RoboForm. Once the program files are copied, you are asked for your name and e-mail address. Enter your details, and continue to the next screen where you can set a master password. This master password will be the only password you have to remember from now on and it cannot be recovered if you forget it. Select all three checkboxes to password-protect all your information. You can also set the time-out period for the automatic logoff so that others don't have access to your accounts while you are away from your desk.

Enter a name for your new identity, and your place (choose 'Other' for India). Fill out all your personal details. In some cases, you may not want to give accurate private information to a particular Web site. To get around this, you can have multiple identities, one identity with complete and accurate information, and another with less than accurate informa-

The Identities form is the last form you ever have to fill

tion. Fill out the first one with all your details, and then right-click Identity Name on the list of identities, and select Clone. Enter a new name, and then edit the details you want to change.

After you're done creating all your identities, click on Finish Setup. You're automatically taken to the RoboForm Web site, where you fill up a test form on their site. This will acquaint you with how forms are filled automatically. Ensure that you can see the RoboForm toolbar in your browser. If you cannot, go to **View > Toolbars > RoboForm** in the Internet Explorer.

When you visit a page with a form, the AutoFill window pops up. Select an identity, and then click the Fill Forms button. If you've entered all your details right, this should work like a breeze. It can't achieve 100 per cent accuracy, and fell short in

The Fill Form box comes up when you visit any page with a form

some cases where there were drop-down boxes. Nevertheless, this will definitely make filling forms much quicker.

AI RoboForm lets you log in to your online

accounts automatically. Saving this information couldn't be simpler. Simply go to the Web site you wish to log in to, and proceed to enter your username and password. As soon as you click the Submit button, a window will come up asking to AutoSave your login information as a Passcard. Enter a name, and save it. You can do this one by one for all your accounts right now, or simply save the information for the next time you want to log in to each account. Over a period of time, all your logins will be automatically saved here, and you can then log in to each one automatically, as needed.

Passwords are saved automatically

After restarting your PC, when you attempt to log in to any of your Passcards, you will be asked for your master password. You only have to enter this once to access all your accounts. To log in to any of your accounts, go to the RoboForm Toolbar and click on Passcards. From the list that comes up, select the account you want to log in to. Your browser will automatically go to the site, and RoboForm will log in for you. Bear in mind that it's just as easy for someone else with access to your desktop, to log in to any of your accounts and read your sensitive data. Worse still, they can view and edit the data that you have saved in RoboForm itself. To stop this from happening, remember to click Logoff on the toolbar whenever you leave your desk.

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Find it on the Mindware CD
AI Roboform 5.4.3

